

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

The idea is to retrain people.



Learning Outcome

Present advice on solving technical problems in a work context and appropriate for the interlocutor.

Can Do Statements

- I can speculate about events.
- I can give advice and recommendations.
- I can talk about jobs and work.

Ask your partner:

- What kind of activities does your company do for employees? Does it offer training programs?
- How successful do you think they will be? Why?





Let's Explore!

Farmani and Janet discuss an urgent **matter***. What is it?

* A "matter" is something that you are discussing or dealing with.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Farmani:** Janet Ellison? I received the message that you have an urgent matter to discuss.
- Janet:** Yes. It would have been helpful if you were honest with us regarding your training needs. Miranda has discovered that there is already a leak over social media about a large layoff. You might want to consider a change of plan.
- Farmani:** I'm not sure how this could impact Polygon.
- Janet:** Image, Mr. Farmani. Any leak through social media is bound to go viral, especially when we're talking about job losses. I can guarantee that a PR event right after this news will result in a demonstration, and that will completely undermine our intentions. We've got to backtrack quickly.
- Farmani:** What are you suggesting? Should I move into a new direction? A new direction requires workers with a different skill-set.
- Janet:** Why don't you retrain staff to fit those needs?
- Farmani:** That can't be as time or cost-effective as hiring new specialists.
- Janet:** What could be less cost-effective than bad press? The word is out but it may not be too late.
- Farmani:** Give me your plan.
- Janet:** You ought to make a statement at the event. Once it's public that you will be retraining current employees the concerns will disappear. I'm sure you'll be recast as a thoughtful employer who is able to keep up with the times.





Let's Practice!

The word is out*. We need to retrain staff.

*"The word is out": means that a piece of news is known, especially if it was secret or will cause changes.

Instructions: Read the dialogue sentences. Select the correct answer.

1. A social media leak is bound to _____.
 ____ go virus
 ____ become a virus
 ____ go viral
2. I can _____ a PR event will result in a demonstration.
 ____ sure that
 ____ guarantee that
 ____ backtrack
3. The demonstration will _____ our _____.
 ____ determine, intent
 ____ undermine, intense
 ____ undermine, intentions
4. What could be less _____ than bad press?
 ____ costly-effect
 ____ cost-effective
 ____ cost-effect



Let's Practice!

Farmani asks Janet for suggestions.

Instructions: Read the sentences and underline all the suggestions.

1. Miranda has discovered that there is a leak. You might want to consider a change of plan.
2. This leak will result in a demonstration that will undermine our intentions. We've got to backtrack immediately.
3. The word is out but it's not too late. You ought to make a statement at the event.
4. Moving in a new direction requires new workers. Why don't you retrain staff?





Extension Activity

Speculate about how successful your products will be.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Look at the 4 products your company is going to release next year.
- With a partner, write down a few recommendations to improve the products.
- Talk about the products and give your recommendations on how to improve the product.
- Speculate about how successful you think they will be in the market.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I write recommendations about a product.

☐ ☐

I discuss my recommendations.

☐ ☐

I make guesses about it using modals of speculation.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to guarantee** (verb): to make a formal promise that something will happen
e.g. I can guarantee that a PR event after this news will result in a demonstration.
- **go viral** (expression): to describe something that becomes very popular and spreads quickly, especially on the internet
e.g. A leak is bound to go viral.
- **to undermine** (noun): to make something or someone become gradually less effective, confident or successful
e.g. This news will undermine our confidence.
- **intention** (noun): a plan in your mind to do something
e.g. This demonstration will undermine our intentions.
- **to backtrack** (verb): to change your intentions or plans
e.g. We need to backtrack quickly.
- **cost-effective** (adjective): best use of money
e.g. What could be less cost-effective than bad press?
- **to recast** (noun): changing the way someone is or appears to be
e.g. I'm sure you will be recast as a thoughtful employer.





Learning Points

Giving Advice & Recommendations

In the Business world, at times, you have an idea, a recommendation or a plan that you think could work for your company. It is important to use proper language to offer those ideas for someone to consider. Here is some language you can use for giving advice and recommendations.

Expressions with Infinitive

The following expressions are used with the base form of the verb:

You *might want to* + verb
We've *got to* + verb
Why *don't* you + verb
You *ought to* + verb
Should I + verb

Examples:

- **You might want to** change plans.
- **Why don't you** consider retraining your entire staff?
- **You ought to** train your staff.
- **Should I** move in a new direction?
- **We've got to** backtrack quickly.





Learning Points

Speculating With Modals

When we don't know whether something is true or not and we need to make a guess about it, we use modal verbs of speculation or certainty. Depending on how sure we are we choose the verbs. Here's an explanation on how to use them correctly.

Saying how certain you are

You use the following verbs/expressions to say that you are **certain** something is **true** or **will** happen:

- something + be + *bound to* + verb
- *I'm sure* + pronoun/noun + *will* + verb
- *I can guarantee that* + clause
- *can't* + verb
- *will* + verb

Speculating

You use the following verbs to say something is possibly true or will possibly happen:

- *could* + verb
- *may* + verb
- *might* + verb

Examples:

- *This news **is bound to** go viral and it **will** affect our company's reputation.*
- *This **can't be** true about our company.*
- ***I'm sure** this news **will** destroy our reputation.*
- *Bad press **could** be really bad for us.*
- *It **may be** too late to do something about it.*

